

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
Saibo Touray,

:

:

:

Plaintiffs

:

-against-

:

City of New York, New York City Police Department,
Police Officer Eula Harris, Shield 9247 of the 44 Precinct,
Detective Wilfredo Benitez, Shield 5619 of the 44 Precinct :
and New York City Police Officers John Doe,

:

Plaintiff's residence is:
64 Jessup Avenue
Bronx, NY 10452

:

Defendants

-----X

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to Answer the Verified Complaint in this action and serve a copy of your answer, or if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons to serve a notice of Appearance on the Plaintiffs attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Verified Complaint.

The basis of venue designated is that the cause of action arose in Bronx County.

Dated: January 25, 2019
Bronx, NY

Yours/etc.,

LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
Attorney for Plaintiffs
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

To: City of New York

New York City Police Department

Police Officer Eula Harris, Shield 9247 of the 44 Precinct

Detective Wilfredo Benitez, Shield 5619 of the 44 Precinct

New York City Police Officers John Doe

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X	:	
Saibo Touray,	:	
	:	
Plaintiffs	:	VERIFIED COMPLAINT
	:	
-against-	:	
	:	
City of New York, New York City Police Department,	:	
Police Officer Eula Harris, Shield 9247 of the 44 Precinct,	:	
Detective Wilfredo Benitez, Shield 5619 of the 44 Precinct :	:	
and New York City Police Officers John Doe,	:	
	:	
Defendants	:	
-----X	:	

Plaintiff, by and through his attorney, JASON A. STEINBERGER, Esq, for his complaint,
alleges upon information and belief as follows:

STATEMENT OF FACTS

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff Saibo Touray, (hereinafter referred to as "TOURAY") resides in Bronx, State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Police Officer Eula Harris, Shield 9247 of the 44 Precinct, (hereinafter referred to as "HARRIS") was employed by the New York City Police Department.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Detective Wilfredo Benitez, 5619 of the 44 Precinct, (hereinafter referred to as "BENITEZ") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the New York City Police Officers John Doe, involved in the arrest of Plaintiff (hereinafter referred to as "DOES") were employed by the New York City Police Department.

5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York State of New York.

6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.

7. On or before about October 12, 2018 notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs' claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.

8. That on or about November 8, 2018 the Honorable Mitchell Danziger deemed the Notice of Claim filed on October 12, 2018, timely as to all causes of action listed herein.

9. That on or about December 5, 2018, a hearing required by Municipal Law 50-H was held. At said hearing Plaintiff testified and set forth the facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York in response to this claim.

10. That on or about December 2, 2017 at approximately 5:00PM in the vicinity of 1310 Sheridan Avenue, Bronx, NY Plaintiff was waiting for his uncle, who lives at the above address, to come outside so they could go out to eat when HARRIS and BENITEZ stopped Plaintiff for no reason whatsoever.

11. When Plaintiff requested to know why he was being arrested, Plaintiff was thrown to the ground by HARRIS and BENITEZ, handcuffed and arrested.
12. That as a result of being thrown to the ground, Plaintiff's hands and body were injured.
13. That at no time had Plaintiff engaged in any criminal or unlawful conduct.
14. That at no time did Plaintiff assault or attempt to assault a police officer.
15. That after Plaintiff was arrested he was transported to the 44 precinct.
16. That after Plaintiff arrived at the local Bronx precinct he was placed into a cell with other male prisoners.
17. That after being held for several hours at the local Bronx precinct, Plaintiff was transported to Bronx County Central Booking located at 215 East 161 Street, Bronx, NY 10451.
18. That on or about December 4, 2017 Plaintiff was arraigned in Bronx County Criminal Court on docket 2017BX046282, charging him with Obstructing Governmental Administration, Disorderly Conduct, Attempt Assault, Harassment and Resisting Arrest.
19. That at the time of his arraignment, Plaintiff was released and ordered to return to court.
20. That on and between December 4, 2017 and October 5, 2018 Plaintiff made numerous court appearances until the matter was adjourned in contemplation of dismissed upon application of the Office of the Bronx District Attorney.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

21. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 18, as if more fully stated herein at length.
22. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.

23. That as a result of the actions of Defendants, Plaintiff was seriously injured due to the intentional manner in which Defendants, their agents, servants, employees and/or licensees treated Plaintiff and he was wounded, suffered, still suffers, and will continue to suffer for some time great physical pain and great bodily injuries and became sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remained for a considerable length of time.

24. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

25. That as a result of the actions by Defendants Plaintiff was traumatized and fears for his physical safety when he sees and encounters members of the New York City Police Department from that day and onward.

26. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.

27. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff was forced to miss multiple days from work.

28. That as a result of the Defendants' actions Plaintiff sustained damage to his person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

29. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 28, as if more fully stated herein at length.

30. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants violated the rights of Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable.

31. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff did, nevertheless, unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward her and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for his constitutional rights. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

32. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 33, as if more fully stated herein at length.

33. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec. 1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable. Thus Plaintiff Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

34. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 33, as if more fully stated herein at length.

35. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff to suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable. The verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution on and of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

36. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to cooperate in a prosecution when Plaintiff should never have been arrested.

Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

37. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by claiming that Plaintiff refused to follow a lawful directive of a police officer.

38. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by claiming that Plaintiff attempted to assault a police officer.

39. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by claiming that Plaintiff resisted arrest.

40. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

41. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 40, as if more fully stated herein at length.

42. At all times pertinent hereto, HARRIS, BENITEZ and DOES were acting within the scope of their employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and City of New York.

43. The City of New York and New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the intentional torts that HARRIS, BENITEZ and DOES committed within the scope of their employment.

44. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that HARRIS targeted members of the 44 precinct, specifically, people of African descent and continued to employ HARRIS.

45. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that HARRIS falsely arrested Moutawakil Ourotcha for False Personation on November 25, 2017 in that the arrest was declined to prosecuted by the Office of the Bronx District Attorney. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ her.

46. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that HARRIS falsely arrested Bangaly Sumbundu, Mohammadou Touray and Amadou Diallo for trespass on November 19, 2017 in that the cases against each were dismissed by the Office of the Bronx District Attorney. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ her.

47. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that BENITEZ falsely arrested Shaquille Holder on September 24, 2011 for trespassing in his own building in that the case was dismissed by the Office of the Bronx District Attorney. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

48. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that BENITEZ falsely arrested Halidou Omaru in that Mr. Omaru filed suit against BENITEZ for False Arrest under index number 25528/2014 and that the City of New York and New York City Police Department settled the claim with a monetary award. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

49. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that BENITEZ falsely arrested Kazeem Lhabik in that Mr. Lhabik filed suit against BENITEZ for False Arrest under index number 22060/2014 and that the City of New York and New York City Police Department settled the claim with a monetary award. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

50. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that BENITEZ falsely arrested Olusegun Grant, Saibo Sidibeh and Muhammed Gumaneh for trespass on February 17, 2017 under index number 20014/2016. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

51. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that BENITEZ falsely arrested Kabine Kaba for Disorderly Conduct on September 22, 2017 under claim number 2017PI032475. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

52. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department knew that BENITEZ assaulted Kabine Kaba by spraying him with pepper spray for absolutely no reason on September 22, 2017 in that the incident was captured on video. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

53. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 42, as if more fully stated herein at length.

54. The City of New York and New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to HARRIS, BENITEZ and DOES constitutes a willful and wanton indifference and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of private citizens, including Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

55. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 44, as if more fully stated herein at length.

56. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff.

57. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants as follows:

On the first cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts;

On the second cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts, together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the third cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the fourth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of

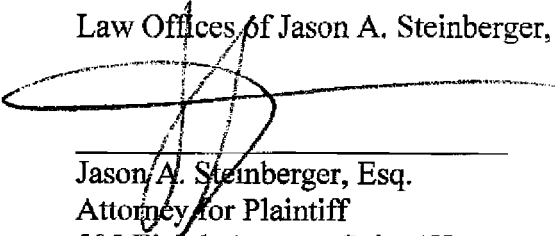
this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the Defendants' wanton and willful actions;

On the fifth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts

On the sixth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts.

On the seventh cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

Law Offices of Jason A. Steinberger, LLC

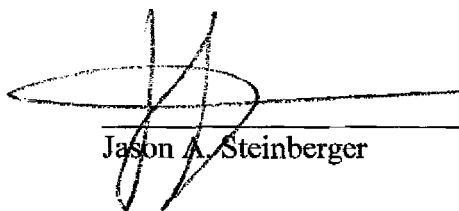


Jason A. Steinberger, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

STATE OF NEW YORK: COUNTY OF NEW YORK

The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury, affirms the following to be true: Affirmant has read the foregoing Complaint and the contents thereof ; the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge, except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters affirmant believes it to be true; and the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not by the plaintiff is because the plaintiff is not within the county in which your affirmant maintains his principal office. The grounds of affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon affirmant's knowledge are communications with the plaintiff, review of records and documents within affirmant's possession.

Affirmed: January 28, 2019



Jason A. Steinberger

**Index Number:
SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**

SAIBO TOURAY,

Plaintiffs

-against-

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE
OFFICER EULA HARRIS, SHIELD 9247 OF THE 44 PRECINCT, DETECTIVE
WILFREDO BENITEZ, SHIELD 5619 OF THE 44 PRECINCT AND NEW YORK CITY
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE,**

Defendant.

SUMMONS AND COMPLAINT

**LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
505 Eighth Avenue
Suite 701
New York, NY 10018**

To:
Attorney (s) for Defendant(s)

Service of a copy of the within

is hereby admitted.

Dated:

Attorney(s) for

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE

☐ that the within is a (certified) true copy of
☐ entered in the office of the clerk of the within named Court on

**NOTICE
OF ENTRY**

☐ that an Order of which the within is a true copy will be presented for settlement to the Hon.
☐ once of the Judges of the within named Court,

**NOTICE OF
SETTLEMENT**

at
on

200 , at m.

Dated:

**JASON A. STEINBERGER, ESQ.
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 701
New York, NY 10018**

To:
Attorney(s) for